A-A-401A
January 29, 1980
SUPERSEDING
A-A-401
April 25, 1979

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TYPEWRITER, MANUAL, NONPORTABLE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This description covers manual (nonportable) typewriters for general office use, as distinguished from those models referred to as "portable" by industry. The typewriters shall be currently marketed commercial models designed for office use and shall be drawn from current production lots.

Salient characteristics:

Vertical line space selection with a minimum of two positions for 1 and 2 line spaces.
Variable vertical line spacer.
Carriage release.
Platen release (paper removal).
Margin stops, right and left.
Paper bail with two or more bail rolls.
Line ruling device.
Alignment guide.
Line finder permits ratchet free movement of platen and return to original line of type.
Carriage return level.
Adjustable paper guide.
Right margin warning device.
Minimum of three ribbon positions (red, black, and stencil).
Tabulator key (bar).
Tabulator set.
Tabulator clear, single and total.
Shift key, right and left.
Shift lock.
Shift lock release, right and left.
Margin release.
Backspace.
Space bar.
Touch adjustment.
Automatic ribbon reverse.
Dust cover.
Color choice (as available in manufacturers commercial line).

Mechanical requirements. Unless otherwise specified, the typewriter shall be equipped with the manufacturer's standard elite type style, complete with upper and lower case characters.

The keyboard shall have a minimum of 44 keys and 88 characters, and the arrangement of the 44 basic printing keys shall be in accordance with American National Standard for Typewriter Keyboard Arrangement ANSI X4.7-1973 of the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). Typewriters shall be available with carriages accommodating paper widths and associated printed line widths up to dimensions as specified from the table below:

PAPER WIDTH* AND ASSOCIATED PRINT LINE WIDTH (INCHES)

12.5-inch paper width with 12-inch print line width
14.5-inch paper width with 14-inch print line width
17.5-inch paper width with 17-inch print line width
23.5-inch paper width with 23-inch print line width
34.0-inch paper width with 33-inch print line width

*Carriages furnished shall not accept platens for paper widths greater than the width specified from the above selection.

FSC 7430

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The typewriter shall be equipped with resilient feet or base to minimize movement and prevent marring of furniture. The typewriter shall also have a minimum clearance of 3-1/4 inches between the bottom of the extended carriage and the surface upon which the machine rests. All operating controls must be easily accessible. This requirement precludes any controls on the back of the machine.

Identification. Each typewriter shall have the manufacturer's serial number permanently and legibly stamped or affixed on a major component in readily accessible location. In addition, each typewriter shall be permanently and legibly marked in a conspicuous location with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Recovered materials. The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

Packaging, packing, and marking. The typewriters shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice and packed in a fiberboard box that will assure acceptance by common carrier and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The shipping container shall be in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification. Shipping containers shall be marked as specified in the contract or order.

ANSI X4.7-1973 is available from the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

GSA DC-01004385